

動詞のグループ Verb Groups

Verbs can be divided into three categories according to their conjugations. In order to memorize how verbs conjugate, it is important to first understand these three categories.

Group 1 (U-verbs)

1. Verbs that end in vowel sounds other than [-ru].

-u	-ku	-su	-tsu
かう [kau] (buy)	かく [kaku] (write)	はなす [hanasu] (speak)	まつ [matsu] (wait)
-nu	-bu	-mu	-gu
しぬ [shinu] (die)	あそぶ [asobu] (play)	のむ [nomu] (drink)	およぐ [oyogu] (swim)

2. Verbs that end in [-ru] whose final vowel before [-ru] is [a], [u], or [o].

-aru	-uru	-oru
すわる [suwaru] (sit)	ふる [furu] (shake)	とる [toru] (take)
わかる [wakaru] (understand)	つくる [tsukuru] (make)	のる [noru] (ride)

Group 2 (Ru-verbs)

Verbs that end in [-ru] whose final vowel before [-ru] is [i] or [e].

-iru	-eru
みる [miru] (look)	たべる [taberu] (eat)
おきる [okiru] (wake up)	あける [akeru] (open)

Exceptions: かえる [kaeru] (go back/home), はいる [hairu] (enter), きる [kiru] (cut), いる [iru] (need), しる [shiru] (know), はしる [hashiru] (run) ⇒ **U-verbs**

Group 3 (Irregular Verbs)

する [suru] (do)	くる [kuru] (come)
勉強する [benkyōsuru] (study)	持つてくる [mottekuru] (bring)

Let's Practice!

Classify the verbs below into the correct category.

会う [au] (meet)	おりる [oriru] (go down)	行く [iku] (go)	怒る [okoru] (get angry)	呼ぶ [yobu] (call)
休む [yasumu] (take a rest)	着る [kiru] (wear)	寝る [neru] (go to bed)	貸す [kasu] (lend)	入る [hairu] (enter)
持つ [motsu] (hold)	帰る [kaeru] (go back/home)	登る [noboru] (climb)	辞める [yameru] (quit)	いる [iru] (be)
落ちる [ochiru] (fall)	買い物する [kaimonosuru] (go shopping)	借りる [kariru] (borrow)	連れてくる [tsuretekuru] (bring a person)	急ぐ [isogu] (hurry)
切る [kiru] (cut)	手伝う [tetsudau] (help)	読む [yomu] (read)	いる [iru] (need)	ある [aru] (be)

Group 1 (U-verbs)

Group 2 (Ru-verbs)

Group 3 (Irregular Verbs)